

The Dhāraṇī for Curing the Illness of Indigestion

Toh 785 · Derge Kangyur

མ་ཞ་བྱུའ་ནིད་འབད་བའ་གི་ཟུངས།

The Dhāraṇī for Curing the Illness of Indigestion is a very short ritual text, and in the Tibetan its title appears at the close of the work as a dhāraṇī for removing the sickness of undigested food. It concerns a simple healing practice: a short spell, invoked with homage to the Three Jewels and to the Tathāgata Samantadarśin, the All-Seeing One, is recited over the hand, which is then rubbed on the belly to relieve indigestion. Its brief account also involves the noble Mañjuśrī reciting the spell seven times. The Sanskrit title is not given in the lines supplied here, so it is best left undetermined. Toh 785 in the Kangyur, it belongs to the class of dhāraṇī texts, which preserve protective or practical formulas whose recitation is held to bring about specific benefits.

Svāhā. Having recited the rite over the hand, and having rubbed the belly with it, the illness of indigestion will be cured. This completes the dhāraṇī for curing the illness of indigestion.

Homage to the Three Jewels.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete buddha, Samantadarśin, the All-Seeing One.

Tadyathā: dīri tiṣṭa, taskara baddho 'si, macala macala svāhā.

Having recited this seven times, the noble Mañju

Translator's Notes

- The passage breaks off mid-word at the end, in the middle of the name of the noble Mañjuśrī (or of an invocation to him), so the final sentence is left incomplete. The opening lines are a closing colophon-style instruction followed by the colophon of a preceding short text; the narration follows the order given. The mantra syllables are transliterated from the Tibetan and are not translatable. Their Sanskrit form is uncertain, since the transmitted syllables may be corrupt. The text appears to concern a rite for the illness of indigestion, and the sense of the verb in the opening instruction, "rubbed the belly," follows the Tibetan reading as given. The epithet Kuntu-zigs is rendered Samantadarśin on the standard reconstruction.

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.